

Trichechus manatus

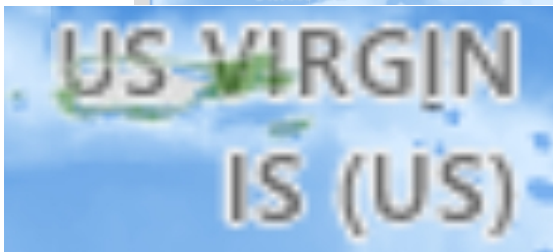
West Indian manatee

Family (Trichechidae)

Kingdom (Animalia)

Status (Threatened)

A large marine mammal found in marine, estuarine, and freshwater habitats. It has a robust body, front flippers, and a rounded, paddle-shaped tail, and is grayish in color. Adults can measure about 3 meters in length and weigh nearly 1,000 pounds. It is protected by federal law due to its vulnerable status.



Location/Habitat

Its distribution is influenced by water temperature, with seasonal north-south migrations. During the fall and winter, when the water temperature drops below 20 °C, it congregates in warm-water refuges, both natural and artificial (such as power plant outfalls), primarily in Florida. During warmer periods, it moves to nearby areas to feed on seagrass beds and aquatic vegetation, frequently returning to the same refuges.

Sources: <https://ecos.fws.gov/ecp/species/4469>

https://www.itis.gov/servlet/SingleRpt/SingleRpt?search_topic=TSN&search_value=180684#null
https://ecos.fws.gov/docs/recovery_plan/861224.pdf